The Sharpe Stability Ratio in Tactical and Static Asset Allocation Backtests: Evidence from 173 Published Strategy Variants

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Abstract

A backtested Sharpe ratio summarises how large a strategy's risk-adjusted return was over a sample, not how it was distributed across the sample. We apply the Sharpe Stability Ratio (SSR) of Bajo Traver and Rodriguez Dominguez (2026), the mean of a rolling 36-month Sharpe ratio divided by a heteroskedasticity and autocorrelation consistent estimate of its long-run standard deviation, to 173 tactical and static asset allocation strategy variants published on one backtesting platform, with completed monthly histories of 18 to 106 years ending in August 2026. We report a fixed-bandwidth descriptive version of the statistic and treat it as a ranking aid. Three descriptive findings follow. First, SSR is imperfectly rank-correlated with the Sharpe ratio (0.61) and with a Deflated Sharpe Ratio computed by the platform's method (0.55): of 152 variants whose Deflated Sharpe Ratio is at least 0.90, 55 have an SSR of at least 0.5 and 97 fall below it. Second, estimated SSR rankings depend strongly on the evaluation period. Aggregate rankings are stable across rolling windows and bandwidths (rank correlations of 0.93 to 0.99 with the baseline specification), but across four calendar subperiods the cross-sectional rank correlation between adjacent periods is −0.06, −0.40 and 0.10, and the S&P 500's own SSR moves from 0.15 in the 2000s to 1.63 in the 2010s. Third, the association between reported turnover and SSR is positive (rank correlation 0.32; 0.25 within tactical variants), and static allocations have the lowest median SSR. A moving block bootstrap places every percentile interval above zero and no 5th percentile above 0.5. Reordering each series' own monthly returns at random gives a benchmark SSR of about 0.4 times the Sharpe ratio at the median history, higher for shorter histories; the ratio of the real SSR to this benchmark is nearly uncorrelated with the Sharpe ratio (rank correlation 0.05) and exceeds one for 129 of the 173 variants, but no single variant's ratio survives a false discovery rate adjustment. We document the estimator, the choices behind it, and their consequences.

1. Introduction

The Sharpe ratio remains the dominant summary of a backtest. Two strategies with the same Sharpe ratio over the same sample can nonetheless have earned it in very different ways: one steadily, the other in a handful of episodes that happened to fall inside the sample. A full-sample inference statistic does not directly summarise the path of rolling Sharpe estimates. The Probabilistic Sharpe Ratio (Bailey and López de Prado, 2012) assesses whether an observed Sharpe ratio is distinguishable from a benchmark given the sample length and the higher moments of returns. The Deflated Sharpe Ratio (Bailey and López de Prado, 2014) compares it with a model-based expected maximum among the trials that produced it. Neither describes how the estimate evolved over time.

Bajo Traver and Rodriguez Dominguez (2026) propose the Sharpe Stability Ratio (SSR) for that purpose. They treat the rolling Sharpe ratio as a time series, show that overlapping windows induce autocorrelation that a naive standard deviation understates substantially (naive-to-HAC

standard deviation ratios of about 0.19 in their synthetic examples and 0.26 to 0.29 in their hedge fund examples), and define stability as the mean of the rolling series divided by a heteroskedasticity and autocorrelation consistent (HAC) estimate of its long-run standard deviation. Their empirical work covers seventeen hedge fund style indices over 29 years.

This paper applies the SSR to a different population: rules-based asset allocation strategies whose histories are simulated rather than lived. The sample is the published catalog of BestFolio, a tactical asset allocation (TAA) research platform, comprising 173 strategy variants with at least ten years of completed monthly history, most of them reconstructions of published models (Faber, 2007; Antonacci, 2014; Keller and Keuning, 2016, 2017, 2018, 2022, 2023, among others) and the static allocations investors compare them with. The histories are long, 486 months at the median and up to 1,274 months, and every variant is scored on the same month-end series with the same execution assumptions. We extend the application to this catalog, examining sensitivity to the evaluation period, retrospective rank persistence across decades, and the association with reported turnover. The platform also publishes a Deflated Sharpe Ratio for each variant, which permits a descriptive comparison of its credibility scores with the estimated SSR values.

Our findings are descriptive and conditional on the estimator we use. SSR values range from 0.15 to 0.91 across the 173 variants, with a median of 0.44. SSR is imperfectly rank-correlated with the Sharpe ratio (0.61) and with the Deflated Sharpe Ratio (0.55). Tactical variants have a higher median SSR than static ones (0.46 against 0.36), and monthly-rebalanced strategies a higher median than daily or annually rebalanced ones. The unadjusted association between reported turnover and SSR is positive. Aggregate rank correlations are high across the tested rolling windows and bandwidths, although individual variants can move by as much as 52 places between bandwidths. Across four calendar subperiods the cross-sectional rank correlation between adjacent periods is −0.06, −0.40 and 0.10, and the S&P 500's own SSR moves from 0.15 in the 2000s to 1.63 in the 2010s. A moving block bootstrap places every variant's 95 percent percentile interval above zero and no variant's 5th percentile above 0.5. A permutation benchmark, the SSR of each series' own returns in random order, is close to 0.4 times the Sharpe ratio at the median history and rises for shorter histories; the ratio of the SSR to that benchmark is nearly uncorrelated with the Sharpe ratio (rank correlation 0.05) and has a median of 1.13, although no single variant's ratio survives a false discovery rate adjustment.

Section 2 relates the SSR to the literature it extends. Section 3 describes the data, the platform's conventions and the sample restrictions. Section 4 states the estimator and the choices behind it. Section 5 presents the cross-sectional results, Section 6 the period sensitivity and robustness analysis, including a permutation benchmark, Section 7 the joint view with the Deflated Sharpe Ratio, and Section 8 the turnover results. Section 9 discusses limitations and Section 10 concludes.

2. Background

2.1 Sharpe ratio inference

Lo (2002) derived the asymptotic distribution of the Sharpe ratio estimator under independent and identically distributed returns, treated stationary returns and time aggregation, and

formulated the serially correlated case in HAC and GMM form. Mertens (2002) gave the estimator's variance under independent but non-normal returns, and Opdyke (2007) showed that the same expression holds under stationary and ergodic returns and extended it to comparisons of Sharpe ratios. Bailey and López de Prado (2012) built the Probabilistic Sharpe Ratio on that variance: an inferential score, under its assumptions, for whether the true Sharpe ratio exceeds a benchmark given the estimate, the sample length, and the skewness and kurtosis of returns. Ledoit and Wolf (2008) proposed HAC standard errors and a studentized time-series bootstrap for comparing Sharpe ratios under dependent returns. López de Prado, Lipton and Zoonekynd (2026) provide a closed-form variance under first-order autocorrelation and non-normality,

$$\sigma^2[\widehat{SR}] = \frac{1}{T}\left(\frac{1+\rho}{1-\rho} - \frac{1+\rho+\rho^2}{1-\rho^2}\hat{\gamma}_3 SR + \frac{1+\rho^2}{1-\rho^2}\frac{\hat{\gamma}_4 - 1}{4} SR^2\right),$$

where ρ is the lag-one autocorrelation of returns, $\hat{\gamma}_3$ the skewness and $\hat{\gamma}_4$ the kurtosis. For the monthly return series studied here the correction is small: the median lag-one autocorrelation across the 219 active variants is −0.03 (tenth and ninetieth percentiles −0.08 and +0.03), and recomputing each variant's Deflated Sharpe Ratio with this variance (using $T-1$ in the denominator, as the platform does) changes scores by between −0.018 and +0.021; one variant, a published one, crosses the platform's 0.90 threshold, downward. The correction is therefore not material to the rankings, although it can move threshold classifications at the margin.

The Deflated Sharpe Ratio (Bailey and López de Prado, 2014) replaces the benchmark of the Probabilistic Sharpe Ratio with the expected maximum Sharpe ratio among K trials, given the cross-sectional variance of Sharpe ratios across those trials. It compares the observed Sharpe ratio with a model-based expected maximum under the assumed no-skill trial distribution. The 2014 paper already discusses dependent trials and an effective number of independent trials; the 2026 paper retains the expected-maximum benchmark while rescaling the standard error of the maximum by the standard deviation of the maximum of K standard normal variables. The platform's published score follows the 2014 formulation, which we take as given here. These statistics describe the full-sample estimate; in the terminology of Bajo Traver and Rodriguez Dominguez (2026) they are point-in-time, and say nothing about how the estimate was distributed across the sample.

2.2 The Sharpe Stability Ratio

For a return series $r_1, \ldots, r_T$ and a window τ, Bajo Traver and Rodriguez Dominguez (2026) define the rolling Sharpe process $Z_t = \acute{r}_{t,\tau}/\hat{\sigma}_{t,\tau}$ for $t = \tau, \ldots, T$, with the sample mean and sample standard deviation over the trailing τ observations. The structural Sharpe Stability Ratio is

$$SSR_0 = \frac{\mu_Z}{\sigma_\infty(Z)},$$

the population mean of the rolling process divided by its long-run standard deviation, with feasible analogue $\widehat{SSR}_0 = \acute{Z}/\hat{\sigma}_{HAC}(Z)$. Their Proposition 3.1 shows that under independent returns a rolling statistic inherits a mechanical autocorrelation $\rho_k \approx 1 - k/\tau$ for lags $k < \tau$ and zero beyond, so that the naive standard deviation of Z captures only about one fifth of its long-

run counterpart in their synthetic examples and between a quarter and three tenths in their hedge fund examples. The HAC estimator is the Newey and West (1987) form with a Bartlett kernel,

$$\hat{\sigma}^2_{HAC}(Z) = \hat{\gamma}_0 + 2\sum_{k=1}^{L}\left(1 - \frac{k}{L+1}\right)\hat{\gamma}_k,$$

with $\hat{\gamma}_k$ the sample autocovariances of Z and L the bandwidth. Under stationarity, mixing, moment and long-run-variance consistency conditions the studentized statistic $\sqrt{N}\,\widehat{SSR}$, with $N = T - \tau + 1$ the number of rolling windows, is asymptotically standard normal under the boundary null, and the authors recommend a moving block bootstrap for finite-sample inference because the overlap-induced dependence makes the asymptotic approximation unreliable. Their hedge fund results range from 0.27 to 0.62 with a 36-month window and an Andrews (1991) bandwidth that selected 15 lags; the sample-size formula $\lfloor 4(N/100)^{2/9} \rfloor$ selected 5 lags on the same data, with SSR levels 34 percent lower under Andrews and a rank correlation of 0.98 between the two. They document that rankings survive changes of window and bandwidth while levels do not, and that stability is conditional on the regime: across three subperiods of their sample the cross-sectional rank correlation of SSR averages 0.31.

SSR measures the average rolling Sharpe ratio relative to its long-run standard deviation, combining performance level, dispersion and serial dependence in one number. Two hedge fund indices with nearly identical Sharpe ratios in their sample (Merger Arbitrage at 1.73 and Equity Market Neutral at 1.72) have SSRs of 0.62 and 0.40. The authors recommend a benchmark Sharpe ratio $SR^* = 0$ for empirical use because the ratio's elasticities diverge as the benchmark approaches the mean rolling Sharpe ratio, define a Credibility-Adjusted SSR as the product of SSR and the Probabilistic Sharpe Ratio, and note that SSR is the more useful of the two when the Probabilistic Sharpe Ratio already exceeds 0.95.

3. Data

3.1 The catalog and the sample

BestFolio maintains a catalog of rules-based asset allocation strategies, each with one or more parameter variants, and publishes for each variant a full-history backtest, periodic signals and summary statistics. The sample is defined on the catalog as it stood on 5 September 2026 (production release release/2026-09-05-8b44fa1): 219 active variants, of which 177 were published on the public leaderboard and 42 were research variants that were tested but not published at that date. The series used here are those of the same 219 variants after the platform restated every backtest on 28 September 2026 (release release/2026-09-28-e9a2a80); Section 3.2 describes the resulting conventions, and the section on changes from version 0.4 the two corrections. All 219 enter the Deflated Sharpe Ratio's count of trials.

The primary sample is the published set less two restrictions. First, three variants of one strategy whose macroeconomic input is known to have been reconstructed with revised rather than point-in-time data are excluded pending restatement; the supplementary file identifies them. Second, the SSR is reported only for variants with at least 120 completed monthly returns, which excludes one further variant with 83 months. The primary sample therefore

holds 173 variants from 92 strategy families. Section 6.3 reports the sensitivity of the headline statistics to the first restriction: including the three excluded variants changes the median SSR by less than 0.01 and the adjacent-decade rank correlations by less than 0.02.

The strategies fall into two types. Tactical variants (142) change their allocation on a schedule according to momentum, trend, breadth, volatility or macroeconomic rules; they include reconstructions of the Global Tactical Asset Allocation family (Faber, 2007), Global Equities Momentum (Antonacci, 2014), and the Protective, Vigilant, Defensive, Bold and Hybrid Asset Allocation family (Keller and Keuning, 2016, 2017, 2018, 2022, 2023), as well as house strategies and community-contributed variants. Static variants (31) are fixed-weight allocations rebalanced on a schedule, from the classic 60/40 to the Permanent Portfolio, the Golden Butterfly and All Weather. By rebalancing frequency there are 121 monthly, 24 daily, 17 annual, 10 quarterly and 1 weekly variants; 52 use leveraged exchange-traded funds or synthetic leverage. Variants of one strategy share rules and often assets, so the 173 series are not independent draws; two variants (a US-equity-only allocation listed under two strategy names) share an identical return path over their whole history. We report the catalog as published and note where family structure matters.

3.2 Series construction and conventions

Every backtest is simulated daily by the platform's engine on adjusted prices. The platform's published methodology states one-way transaction costs of 10 basis points and execution on the session after a signal; the study uses the stored net asset value series and does not re-run the engine. Where an instrument's history is shorter than the backtest, the engine substitutes documented proxies (index funds, futures-based series, or synthetic leverage built from an index), so the earliest histories reach back to the 1920s. Fund histories used as proxies are total return: distributions missing from the primary price provider's records, mostly before 1990, are restored from a second provider and checked against the funds' published returns, and the S&P 500 proxy until early January 1987 is the index's daily total return. Between signals the engine holds the positions bought at the last signal and lets their weights drift with prices; at a signal it trades from the drifted weights to the new target weights, and the one-way turnover reported for a variant is half the sum of absolute differences between the drifted and the target weights at each signal, summed over a year and averaged over the backtest. Daily strategies emit a signal only when their regime or allocation changes, so single-asset regimes trade only when their signal flips; static allocations trade back to their target weights on their rebalancing schedule, and monthly rotations at most once a month.

The stability statistic is computed on monthly returns from completed month-end observations. The restated series end on 25 or 28 September 2026 depending on the series; we drop that partial month and use returns through 31 August 2026. The Stability value on each of the platform's strategy pages keeps the current partial month, following its published Sharpe convention; the rank correlation between the two treatments across the 173 variants is 0.9999, the largest difference in any variant's SSR is 0.016, and the median is 0.444 with completed months and 0.445 with the partial month. Of the 173 variants, 34 start before 1980, 144 before 1990, 166 before 2000 and 172 before 2008; the median history is 486 months and the longest 1,274.

Returns are used with a cash reference of zero, as in the platform's published Sharpe convention: the rolling Sharpe ratio is the mean of raw monthly returns over their standard deviation, not of excess returns over a cash rate. Across a century of changing short rates this raises Sharpe levels in high-rate decades relative to an excess-return definition; every series is treated the same way, and we flag it as a limitation in Section 9. The monthly moments used for the Probabilistic Sharpe Ratio are recomputed from the same returns; the stored monthly Sharpe ratios on the platform agree with the recomputed ones to within 0.006 per month, the difference coming from the partial month they include. The compound growth rate, maximum drawdown and turnover are imported from the platform's leaderboard payload as published on 28 September 2026 and are not recomputed; the Deflated Sharpe Ratio is computed as described in Section 3.3.

Benchmarks are constructed from the same price database: the Vanguard 500 Index Fund (VFINX, from August 1976) as the S&P 500 proxy, the Vanguard Total Bond Market Index Fund (VBMFX, from December 1986) for US bonds, a monthly-rebalanced 60/40 blend of the two, and the gold (GLD, from November 2004), long Treasury (TLT from July 2002, VUSTX from May 1986) and Nasdaq 100 (QQQ, from March 1999) funds. The month-end closes are those of the 5 September 2026 extract with the same total-return corrections as the strategy series: until 5 January 1987 the S&P 500 series is the index's daily total return, which supplies the distributions and capital gains missing from the VFINX record, and the distributions missing from the VBMFX and VUSTX records before 1990 are restored. Their windows are stated with every number.

3.3 The platform's Deflated Sharpe Ratio

The Deflated Sharpe Ratio used here is computed with the platform's own implementation on the paper's trial set: the 219 variants of Section 3.1 count as trials ($K = 219$), the cross-trial variance of monthly Sharpe ratios is taken from that same set, and each variant's own history length and monthly moments enter the Bailey and López de Prado (2014) formula. The resulting no-skill benchmark is an annualised Sharpe ratio of 0.55. The platform's published scores now count every variant with a stored backtest, active or retired, as a trial (238 at the restatement, with a benchmark of 0.56). The same implementation reproduces every published score exactly; across the 173 variants the two sets of scores differ by at most 0.012, and three variants that reach 0.90 with $K = 219$ fall just below it with the platform's count. Treating catalog entries as independent trials overstates the effective number of trials, since variants of one strategy are correlated; raw K is a modelling choice, not a validated search correction, and Section 7 treats the score as the platform's model output rather than as a corrected probability. The values carry six decimals: among the 173 variants there are 155 distinct values, 11 equal to one exactly, and 87 that round to 1.00 at two decimals.

4. Methodology

4.1 Estimator

For each series we compute monthly simple returns $r_1, \ldots, r_T$ from completed month-end net asset values. With window $\tau = 36$ the rolling per-period Sharpe ratio is

$$Z_t = \frac{\acute{r}_{t,\tau}}{\hat{\sigma}_{t,\tau}}, \hat{\sigma}^2_{t,\tau} = \frac{1}{\tau - 1} \sum_{j=0}^{\tau-1} \left(r_{t-j} - \acute{r}_{t,\tau} \right)^2, t = \tau, \ldots, T,$$

with the zero cash reference of Section 3.2 and no annualisation, which cancels in the ratio. Reindex the rolling process as $Z_1, \ldots, Z_N$ with $N = T - \tau + 1$, let $\acute{Z}$ be its mean, and let

$$\hat{\gamma}_k = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{t=k+1}^{N} (Z_t - \acute{Z})(Z_{t-k} - \acute{Z}), \hat{\sigma}^2_L = \hat{\gamma}_0 + 2 \sum_{k=1}^{L} \left(1 - \frac{k}{L+1} \right) \hat{\gamma}_k$$

be the sample autocovariances with divisor N and the Bartlett-kernel long-run variance with bandwidth L. The reported statistic is $\widehat{SSR} = \acute{Z} / \hat{\sigma}_L$ with benchmark $SR^* = 0$ and $L = \tau - 1 = 35$. When a series has fewer rolling estimates than $L + 1$, the bandwidth is reduced to $N - 1$; this never binds in the full-history sample, where $N \geq 185$, but does in some subperiod calculations (Section 6.2). Throughout, K denotes trials, T monthly returns, N rolling estimates and ℓ the bootstrap block length.

The statistic is a fixed-bandwidth descriptive analogue of the structural SSR rather than a consistent estimate of it. A fixed bandwidth does not in general estimate the infinite-horizon variance consistently, and the Bartlett weights recover only part of the overlap-induced dependence even when the bandwidth spans it: under the mechanical-overlap approximation of Proposition 3.1 with $\tau = 36$, the long-run variance ratio $\sigma^2_\infty / \gamma_0 \approx 1 + 2 \sum_{k=1}^{35} (1 - k/36) = 36$, whereas the Bartlett estimate with $L = 35$ approaches $1 + 2 \sum_{k=1}^{35} (1 - k/36)^2 \approx 24$, so the fixed-bandwidth SSR sits roughly 22 percent above the structural target under that approximation. We therefore do not apply the source paper's standard-normal calibration to this specification, and we present the statistic as a ranking aid whose levels are specific to the window and bandwidth stated and, as Section 6.5 shows, to the length of the history.

The statistic is reported as missing, by policy rather than mathematical necessity, when fewer than 120 monthly returns are available; it is undefined when any rolling window has a standard deviation at or below 10^{-12} or when the long-run variance is not positive. At the gate $N = 85$ and $L/N \approx 0.41$; the ten-year threshold is a reporting choice and has not been calibrated in finite samples, although under independent returns with a Sharpe ratio of 1.0 the statistic's mean at the gate is about twice its mean at the sample's median history (Section 6.5). In the primary sample the shortest history is 220 months, so the results say little about behaviour near the gate.

4.2 Bandwidth

The source paper selects the bandwidth with the Andrews (1991) automatic procedure, which returned $L = 15$ on all seventeen of its 29-year monthly series, and reports that the sample-size formula $\lfloor 4 (N/100)^{2/9} \rfloor$ returns $L = 5$ on the same data, with SSR levels 34 percent lower under Andrews and a rank correlation of 0.98 between the two. We have not implemented Andrews' procedure. For a comparative table we prefer one fixed specification for all series, $L = \tau - 1 = 35$, the full extent of the mechanical overlap, so that every strategy is measured by the same estimator and the levels are reproducible from the definition alone. Section 6.3 reports the

sensitivity to $L \in \{5, 15, 35, 71\}$ and to the same sample-size formula, which selects 4 to 6 lags on these series (7, 154 and 12 variants respectively); we call it the sample-size rule to distinguish it from the full data-dependent Newey and West (1994) procedure. The fixed 35-lag specification produces lower point estimates than the fixed 5- and 15-lag specifications and the sample-size rule; we have not established conservative inferential coverage for it, and increasing the bandwidth further does not lower every variant's value.

4.3 Bootstrap

We follow the source paper's recommendation and use a moving block bootstrap (Künsch, 1989): contiguous blocks of ℓ monthly returns are drawn with replacement from the original series and concatenated to its length, the rolling process and the fixed-bandwidth SSR are recomputed on each replicate, and $B = 2,000$ replicates are summarised. Rather than the automatic block length of Politis and White (2004), as corrected by Patton, Politis and White (2009), we report two fixed lengths, $\ell = 12$ and $\ell = 36$ months; results are reported for $\ell = 36$ and checked against $\ell = 12$. Resampling return blocks and recomputing the rolling statistic recreates the mechanical overlap dependence, but a block equal to the window length does not preserve the original regime structure, and we make no claim that it does.

For each variant we report the 2.5th and 97.5th percentiles of the replicates (the percentile interval), the basic interval $[2\widehat{SSR} - q_{0.975}, 2\widehat{SSR} - q_{0.025}]$, and the uncentered bootstrap proportion $q_{\le c} = B^{-1} \sum_b 1\{\widehat{SSR}^{*(b)} \le c\}$ for $c = 0.5$. The proportion is not a posterior probability and is not generated under a null; its only inferential reading is through the one-sided percentile bound, rejecting $H_0 : SSR \le c$ when the 5th bootstrap percentile exceeds c, subject to the method's coverage, which we have not validated. The Monte Carlo standard error of a tail proportion of 0.05 with $B = 2,000$ is about 0.005.

4.4 Companion statistics and verification

For every variant we also compute the platform's Sharpe ratio (annualised mean over annualised sample deviation of the same monthly returns, zero cash reference), the Probabilistic Sharpe Ratio at benchmark zero from the same monthly moments, the Credibility-Adjusted SSR of the source paper, and, for the principal comparisons, the components $\acute{Z}$, the naive standard deviation of Z and its HAC standard deviation. Turnover, strategy type, rebalancing frequency, leverage and risk category are taken from the leaderboard payload; the Deflated Sharpe Ratio is recomputed with 219 trials (Section 3.3).

The statistic was implemented twice: in a standalone script written from the definitions above, and in the platform's production service, written independently from a specification of the same definitions and tested against an independently computed reference fixture. On identical inputs (the restated series with the partial month, as stored by the platform) the two agree to 15 decimals on 217 of the 219 active variants, the remaining two being below the production gate; the check is retained with the replication package. The standalone script also reproduces the Deflated Sharpe Ratios of Section 3.3 to their sixth decimal.

5. Cross-sectional results

5.1 Distribution and resolution

Table 1 summarises the distribution of the full-history SSR across the 173 variants. Values run from 0.15 to 0.91 with a median of 0.44; 56 variants have an SSR of at least 0.5, 6 at least 0.7, and 16 fall below 0.3. Figure 1 shows the distribution against the two main benchmarks: the S&P 500 sits at 0.32 and the 60/40 blend at 0.34, both in the bottom quartile of the catalog.

Table 1. Distribution of the full-history SSR, 173 published variants, completed months through August 2026.

Statistic	Value
Minimum	0.15
10th percentile	0.31
25th percentile	0.36
Median	0.44
75th percentile	0.52
90th percentile	0.63
Maximum	0.91
Distinct values at two decimals	52 (Deflated Sharpe Ratio: 27)
Variants at or above 0.5 / 0.7	56 / 6

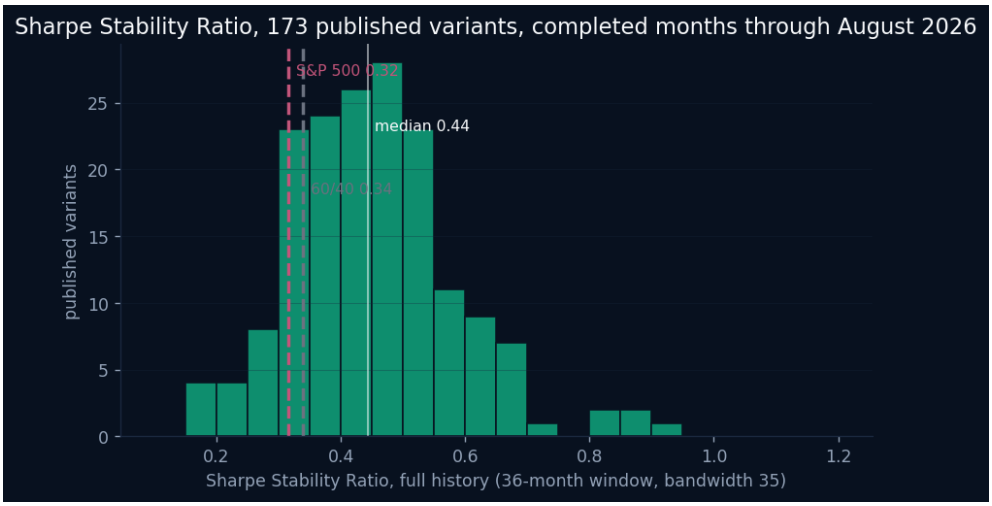


Figure 1. Distribution of the full-history SSR across the 173 published variants (histories start between 1920 and 2008 and end in August 2026; 36-month window, bandwidth 35), with the S&P 500 (VFINX, from 1976) and the 60/40 blend (from 1987) marked.

At two decimals the SSR takes 52 distinct values across the 173 variants and the Deflated Sharpe Ratio 27, with 87 variants rounding to 1.00. The Deflated Sharpe Ratio retains more information than its rounded display suggests (155 distinct values at six decimals, of which 11 are exactly one), so the comparison is one of resolution at the precision commonly displayed rather than of the underlying statistics.

5.2 Relation to level and to credibility

Table 2 reports Spearman rank correlations between SSR and the companion statistics. The correlation with the Sharpe ratio is 0.61, indicating imperfect rank concordance. Figure 2 shows the joint distribution with a few named strategies. The correlations with the Deflated Sharpe Ratio and the Probabilistic Sharpe Ratio are 0.55 and 0.43; their differences from the Sharpe correlation may reflect sample length, higher moments and numerical ties. SSR is only weakly related to the level of return (0.18 with the compound annual growth rate) and moderately to the depth of the worst drawdown (0.49; shallower drawdowns go with higher SSR).

Table 2. Spearman rank correlation of the full-history SSR with companion statistics, 173 published variants.

Companion statistic	Rank correlation with SSR
Sharpe ratio	0.61
Deflated Sharpe Ratio	0.55
Probabilistic Sharpe Ratio at zero	0.43
Maximum drawdown (less negative is higher)	0.49
Annual turnover	0.32
Compound annual growth rate	0.18

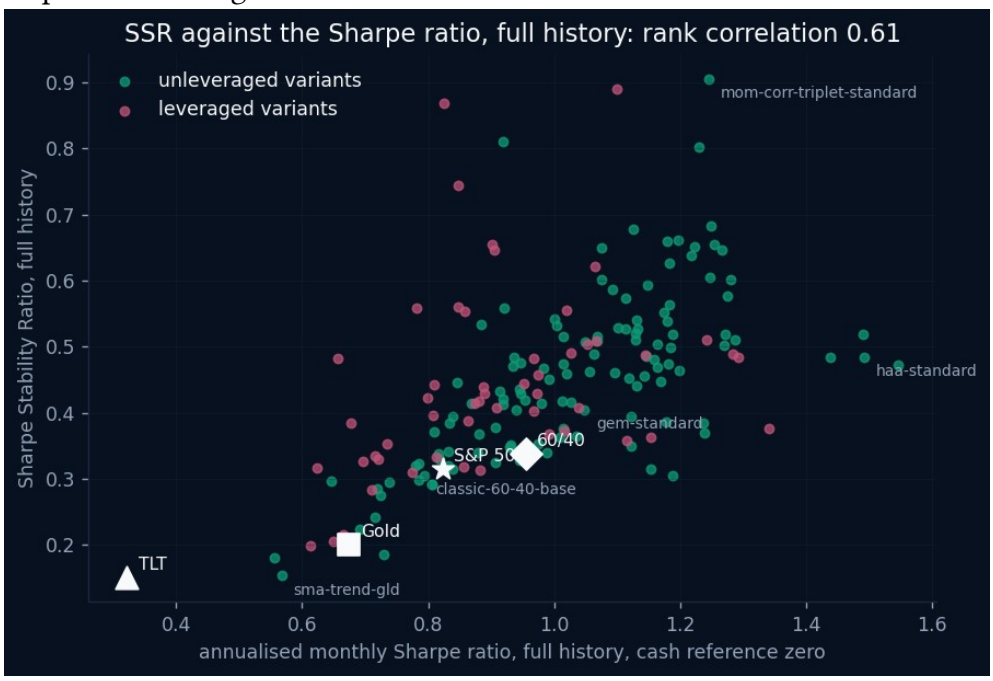


Figure 2. Full-history SSR against the annualised monthly Sharpe ratio (zero cash reference), 173 published variants, benchmarks marked. Rank correlation 0.61.

5.3 Groups

Table 3 gives medians by strategy type, rebalancing frequency, leverage and risk category, with every category shown so that the counts reconcile. Tactical variants have a higher median SSR than static ones (0.46 against 0.36), and the difference holds at both quartiles. Among frequency groups with more than one variant, monthly-rebalanced strategies have the highest median (0.47); daily strategies (0.37) and annually rebalanced allocations (0.35) the lowest; the single weekly variant scores 0.81. Leveraged variants have a slightly lower median than unleveraged ones (0.42 against 0.46). By the platform's risk category the medians are 0.49, 0.46 and 0.39 for conservative, moderate and aggressive variants. These ratios alone do not identify the contribution of numerator and denominator; for the record, the median annualised mean rolling Sharpe ratio is 1.19, 1.08 and 0.92 in the same three groups, so the aggressive group has both a lower average rolling Sharpe ratio and a lower SSR.

Table 3. Median full-history SSR by group (interquartile range in brackets), 173 published variants.

Group	n	Median SSR
Tactical	142	0.46 [0.38, 0.53]
Static	31	0.36 [0.32, 0.46]
Monthly rebalancing	121	0.47 [0.38, 0.53]
Weekly rebalancing	1	0.81
Quarterly rebalancing	10	0.42 [0.35, 0.45]
Daily rebalancing	24	0.37 [0.32, 0.42]
Annual rebalancing	17	0.35 [0.32, 0.49]
Unleveraged	121	0.46 [0.36, 0.53]
Leveraged	52	0.42 [0.36, 0.49]
Conservative risk	16	0.49 [0.43, 0.52]
Moderate risk	105	0.46 [0.37, 0.52]
Aggressive risk	46	0.39 [0.33, 0.44]
No risk category	6	0.48 [0.40, 0.53]

5.4 The extremes

Table 4 lists the twelve highest and twelve lowest full-history SSR values. The top is dominated by monthly momentum rotations with diversified defensive legs: the Momentum-Correlation Triplet family (0.80 to 0.91), the DMS Triad family (0.59 to 0.68) and DMS GPMv (0.66), Pragmatic Asset Allocation (0.68) and the KISS momentum blends (0.56 to 0.66); these family ranges include members that fall below the top-twelve cutoff of 0.66. The bottom is a mix of single-asset trend rules on bonds and gold (0.15 to 0.18), daily volatility-regime strategies (0.20 to 0.22), a gold-based cross-asset rule (0.22), a monthly risk-parity blend of gold and small-cap value run without its trend filter (0.19) and static allocations (a static leveraged three-asset mix at 0.28, a global 60/40 and an all-equity US allocation at 0.29). Two of the three century-long

series, Paired Switching and UIS from 1920, sit in the bottom twelve on full history; the third, the classic 60/40 from 1923, ranks 156th of 173 with an SSR of 0.31.

Table 4. Highest and lowest full-history SSR among the 173 published variants. Sharpe is the annualised monthly-mean ratio with a zero cash reference; DSR the Deflated Sharpe Ratio of Section 3.3; the interval is the 95 percent percentile moving block bootstrap interval with 36-month blocks. The twelfth- and thirteenth-lowest values belong to the two variants that share an identical return path (Section 3.1); one of them is shown.

Variant	From	Sharpe	DSR	SSR	95% interval	Turnover
Triplet, standard	1987	1.25	1.000	0.91	[0.44, 1.10]	3.9
Triplet, 1.5x leverage	1987	1.10	0.999	0.89	[0.41, 1.02]	4.8
Low-Initiative LETF v2	2002	0.82	0.904	0.87	[0.32, 1.02]	14.6
AlphaOne Momentum	1993	0.92	0.986	0.81	[0.42, 1.05]	14.0
Triplet, plus	1986	1.23	1.000	0.80	[0.40, 1.09]	4.8
RVol Shifter, cash only	2003	0.85	0.926	0.75	[0.35, 1.28]	9.7
DMS Triad	1985	1.25	1.000	0.68	[0.40, 0.90]	3.1
Pragmatic Asset Allocation	1986	1.13	1.000	0.68	[0.38, 0.93]	2.5
KISS Momentum 70/30	1986	1.20	0.999	0.66	[0.37, 1.06]	2.7
DMS Triad, plus	1985	1.18	1.000	0.66	[0.37, 0.88]	3.2
DMS GPMv	1988	1.25	1.000	0.66	[0.39, 1.15]	4.5
TQQQ Quadrant, buffered	1996	0.90	0.971	0.66	[0.26, 0.96]	0.9
…						
US stock market, 100%	1988	0.81	0.926	0.29	[0.15, 0.62]	0.0
Global 60/40	1988	0.72	0.827	0.29	[0.13, 0.53]	0.0
UPRO/ZROZ/GLD static	1986	0.71	0.819	0.28	[0.14, 0.58]	0.2
Paired Switching SPY/TLT	1920	0.72	0.946	0.28	[0.17, 0.37]	2.9
UIS	1920	0.72	0.940	0.24	[0.19, 0.37]	2.1
Gold Cross-Asset	1986	0.69	0.794	0.22	[0.10, 0.50]	1.6
Regime Detector	1990	0.67	0.744	0.22	[0.08, 0.49]	2.2
VIX Shield, leveraged	1990	0.65	0.731	0.21	[0.08, 0.68]	4.7
Regime Detector, smart leverage	1990	0.61	0.637	0.20	[0.05, 0.47]	2.2
Schwoerer RP Gold/SCV, no filter	1986	0.73	0.855	0.19	[0.09, 0.44]	0.6
SMA Trend, long Treasuries	1991	0.56	0.508	0.18	[0.07, 0.46]	1.8
SMA Trend, gold	1991	0.57	0.538	0.15	[0.02, 0.43]	1.7

Table 5 shows the same statistics for a set of widely followed strategies, with the components of the ratio for two of them. Hybrid Asset Allocation, the highest-Sharpe strategy in the table at 1.49, has a full-history SSR of 0.48: all 595 of its rolling estimates are positive, with a

minimum annualised value of 0.26, and its annualised mean rolling Sharpe ratio is 1.57, but the HAC standard deviation of the rolling series (0.94 in per-period units) is five times its naive standard deviation (0.18), and it is the HAC figure that the ratio divides by. Its SSR on the window since 2000 is 0.89. The Momentum-Correlation Triplet has a lower mean rolling Sharpe ratio (1.23 annualised) and a much lower HAC standard deviation (0.39), which is what puts it at the top. Global Equities Momentum, with a Sharpe ratio of 1.05, has an SSR of 0.41 and a bootstrap proportion of 0.83 at or below 0.5. The classic 60/40 has a Sharpe ratio comparable to several tactical strategies and a lower SSR, which is the pattern the group medians summarise; the Golden Butterfly, at 0.49, is an exception, above the tactical median of 0.46, as is All Weather, another static allocation, at 0.52.

Table 5. Selected widely followed strategies. Sharpe and DSR are full-history; SSR is shown for the full history and for windows starting in January 2000 and January 2008; the final column is the proportion of 36-month-block bootstrap replicates at or below 0.5 for the full-history estimate, an uncentered proportion whose one-sided reading depends on the method's coverage (Section 4.3).

Strategy	From	Sharpe	DSR	SSR full	2000 on	2008 on	q ≤ 0.5
HAA, Hybrid AA	1974	1.49	1.000	0.48	0.89	0.91	0.22
BAA-G12, Bold AA	1986	1.28	1.000	0.60	0.51	0.50	0.22
DAA-G12, Defensive AA	1986	1.29	1.000	0.51	0.48	0.48	0.42
PAA, Protective AA	1986	1.27	1.000	0.52	0.42	0.43	0.42
LAA, Lethargic AA	1986	1.18	1.000	0.63	0.69	0.77	0.43
Vitral Multi-Asset Momentum	1986	1.25	1.000	0.60	0.57	0.53	0.26
Momentum-Corr. Triplet	1987	1.25	1.000	0.91	0.90	0.77	0.10
GTAA-5, Global Tactical AA	1986	1.14	1.000	0.46	0.40	0.85	0.61
Accelerating Dual Momentum	1986	1.10	1.000	0.53	0.51	0.60	0.44
GEM, Global Eq. Momentum	1986	1.05	0.998	0.41	0.38	0.52	0.83
S&P 500 200-day trend	1991	1.02	0.994	0.46	0.60	0.57	0.77
Century Momentum	1928	0.94	1.000	0.40	0.59	0.66	0.96
Golden Butterfly	1988	1.15	0.999	0.49	0.53	0.62	0.60
All Weather	1972	1.07	1.000	0.52	0.42	0.38	0.65
Classic 60/40	1923	0.79	0.989	0.31	0.37	0.62	1.00
Buy the Dip (TQQQ sleeve)	1985	1.04	0.990	0.41	0.94	1.01	0.55

6. Period sensitivity and robustness

6.1 Benchmarks and the evaluation window

Table 6 reports the SSR of the benchmarks on the full available history and on windows starting in January 2000 and January 2008, both ending in August 2026. The S&P 500 scores

0.32 on the full history and 0.29 on the 2000 window, and 153 of the 166 published variants with data over that window exceed it. On the 2008 window the S&P 500 scores 0.74, the Nasdaq 100 0.88 and the 60/40 blend 0.60, and 53 of 172 variants exceed the S&P 500. Figure 3 illustrates the two rolling Sharpe paths behind one pair of numbers, Hybrid Asset Allocation and the S&P 500: the first never crossed zero and the second spent 2002 to 2004 and late 2008 to 2010 below it, before holding high for a decade. The figure shows the paths; it does not measure the return cost of defensive positioning, and Table 7 does not either.

Table 6. SSR of benchmark series on three windows, all ending in August 2026. The 2000 and 2008 windows are shown only where the series covers them from the start.

Series	From	Sharpe	SSR full	2000 on	2008 on
S&P 500 (VFINX)	1976	0.82	0.32	0.29	0.74
60/40 (VFINX/VBMFX)	1987	0.96	0.34	0.35	0.60
US bonds (VBMFX)	1987	1.16	0.33	0.30	0.23
Long Treasuries (VUSTX)	1986	0.56	0.24	0.19	0.12
Nasdaq 100 (QQQ)	1999	0.56	0.27	0.30	0.88
Gold (GLD)	2004	0.67	0.20	n/a	0.17
Long Treasuries (TLT)	2002	0.32	0.15	n/a	0.11
Variants above the S&P 500				153 of 166	53 of 172
Variants above 60/40				132 of 166	97 of 172

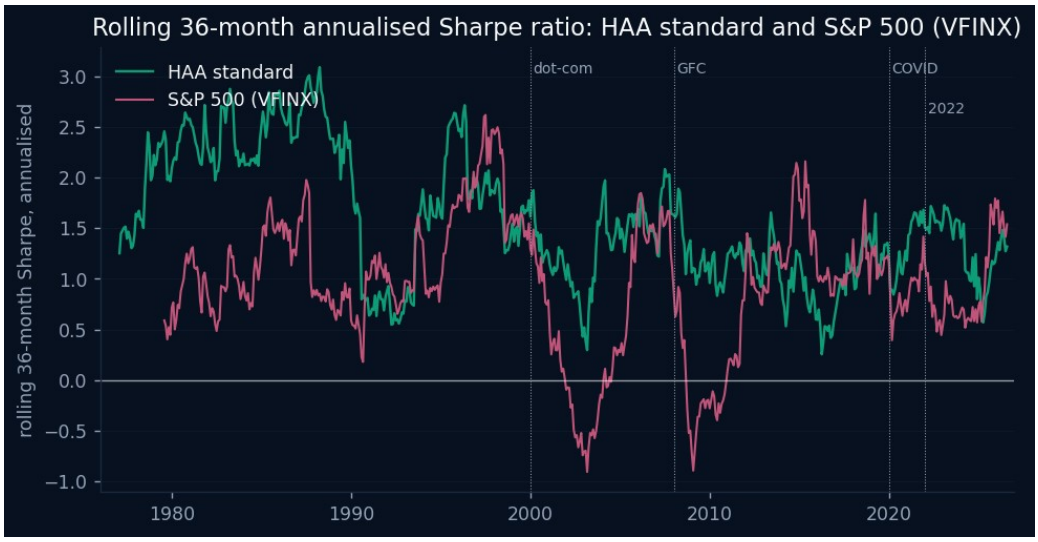


Figure 3. Rolling 36-month annualised Sharpe ratio of Hybrid Asset Allocation (rolling series from February 1977) and the S&P 500 proxy VFINX (from August 1979), through August 2026.

Figure 4 plots each variant's SSR on the 2000 window against its SSR on the 2008 window for the 166 variants that have both. The rank correlation between the two windows is 0.53, and between the full history and the 2008 window 0.32 (0.77 for the 2000 window, which shares most of its history with the full sample). Relative rankings change between overlapping evaluation windows, so group comparisons need common calendar dates; Table 7 uses common subperiods, although its cohorts still differ in size and, within the first period, in history length.

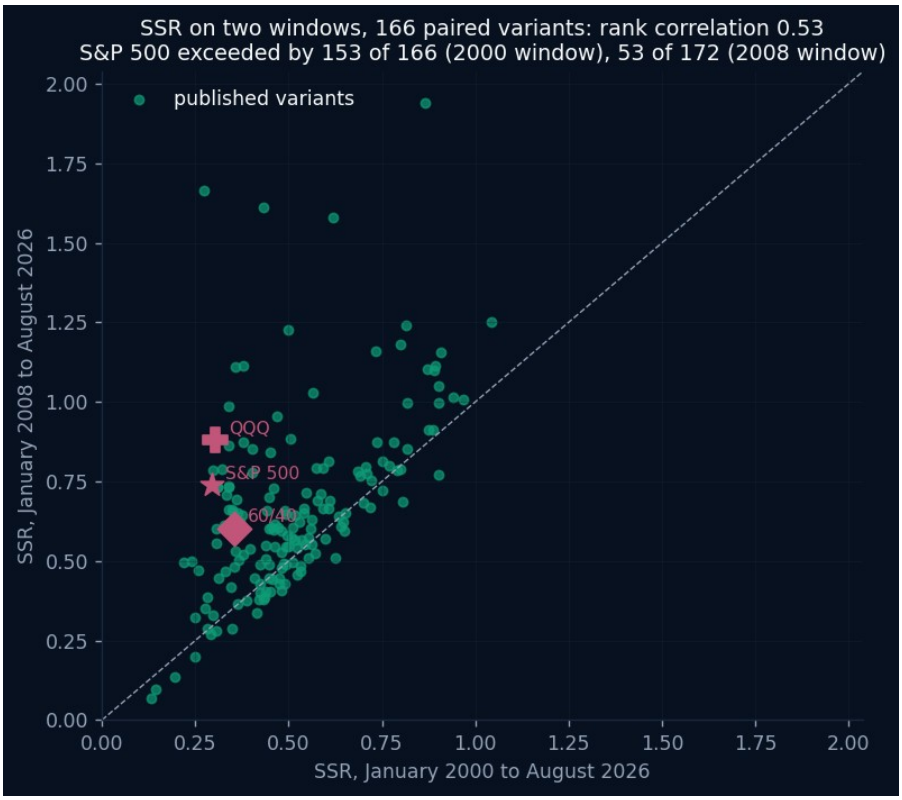


Figure 4. SSR on the January 2000 to August 2026 window against SSR on the January 2008 to August 2026 window, 166 paired variants, benchmarks marked. The counts in the title refer to the 166-variant 2000 cohort and the 172-variant 2008 cohort of Table 6.

6.2 Subperiods

To examine whether the cross-sectional ordering persists, we split the calendar into four subperiods, before 2000, 2000 to 2009, 2010 to 2019, and January 2020 to August 2026, and recompute the SSR inside each for every published variant with at least 72 monthly returns in it. The cohorts hold 160, 172, 173 and 174 variants; the last includes the 83-month variant excluded from the full-history tables. The last subperiod holds 80 completed monthly returns and 45 rolling estimates, the 2010s exactly 120 returns for every variant, and the pre-2000 period between 73 and 954 returns depending on the variant. The subperiods are therefore not four equivalent decades. Table 7 reports the medians, the benchmarks and the cross-sectional rank correlations between subperiods with their pairwise sample sizes.

Table 7. SSR by subperiod: medians across published variants (72-month minimum, so levels are not comparable with the full-history values), medians by strategy type, benchmark values (TLT's 2000s value rests on 89 returns), and Spearman rank correlations of the cross-section between subperiods (pairwise n in brackets).

	Before 2000	2000 to 2009	2010 to 2019	2020 to Aug 2026
Variants with an estimate	160	172	173	174
Median SSR, all	0.69	0.81	0.96	0.81

	Before 2000	2000 to 2009	2010 to 2019	2020 to Aug 2026
Median SSR, tactical	0.65	0.94	0.87	1.01
Median SSR, static	0.82	0.35	1.58	0.61
S&P 500 (VFINX)	0.52	0.15	1.63	0.81
60/40 (VFINX/VBMFX)	0.74	0.23	1.60	0.59
US bonds (VBMFX)	0.96	1.05	0.78	−0.03
Long Treasuries (TLT, from Aug 2002)	n/a	3.38	0.80	−0.47
Nasdaq 100 (QQQ)	n/a	0.13	2.23	0.70
Rank correlation with before 2000		−0.06 (160)	−0.03 (160)	−0.27 (160)
Rank correlation with 2000 to 2009			−0.40 (172)	−0.07 (172)
Rank correlation with 2010 to 2019				0.10 (173)

Between adjacent subperiods the rank correlation of the cross-section is −0.06, −0.40 and 0.10. Higher estimated SSR in the 2000s is associated with lower estimated SSR in the 2010s; this is an imperfect association rather than a complete reversal, and it is not an artefact of the bandwidth: the 2000s-to-2010s correlation is −0.39, −0.39, −0.40 and −0.29 under $L=5$, 15, 35 and 71 (the bandwidth is capped at one less than the number of rolling estimates, which binds for six variants in the 2000s under the 71-lag specification). The benchmarks move with it. The S&P 500 goes from 0.15 to 1.63 between the two decades and the 60/40 blend from 0.23 to 1.60, while the median static variant goes from 0.35 to 1.58 and the median tactical variant from 0.94 to 0.87; in the 2020 window the ordering of the two types reverses again (1.01 against 0.61). The results are consistent with period dependence in estimated SSR, but differences in samples, estimators and estimation uncertainty prevent a stronger comparison with the hedge fund findings of Bajo Traver and Rodriguez Dominguez (2026), whose average subperiod rank correlation is 0.31.

Several explanations remain to be separated, and the design here does not separate them: finite-sample variability of the estimated denominator when the period holds few rolling estimates (at most 45 in the last subperiod against a 35-lag bandwidth), the removal of between-regime variation when the period is short, the restarting of rolling windows at each boundary, unequal history lengths across variants within a period, and genuine changes in how strategies behaved. Short subperiods create uncertainty in both levels and rankings. Ordinary standard errors for these rank correlations would also be inappropriate, because the variants share returns and belong to related families; we report the correlations as descriptive statistics with their sample sizes.

6.3 Window, bandwidth and sample sensitivity

Table 8 reports the sensitivity of the cross-section to the rolling window and to the HAC bandwidth. The first four rows change the window and the bandwidth together ($L=\tau-1$), as the definition does; the next two hold the bandwidth at 35 and change the window alone. Rankings are similar across windows of 24, 36, 48 and 60 months (rank correlation 0.95, 0.98 and 0.98 between adjacent lengths; 0.85 between 24 and 60) and levels rise with the window

(medians 0.42 to 0.48), as in the source paper. The bandwidth moves levels much more: the median SSR is 0.86 with 5 lags, 0.57 with 15, 0.44 with 35 and 0.42 with 71, and the sample-size rule gives 0.86. Rank correlations with the 35-lag baseline are 0.98, 0.99, 0.93 and 0.97, but individual variants can move substantially: one moves 52 places between the 35- and 71-lag specifications. Comparisons should state both window and bandwidth choices, and high aggregate rank correlations in this sample do not guarantee agreement for individual strategies or other datasets.

Table 8. Sensitivity of the cross-section to the rolling window and the HAC bandwidth, 173 published variants.

Specification	Median SSR	Rank correlation with baseline
Window 24 months, bandwidth 23	0.42	0.95 (with 36/35)
Window 36 months, bandwidth 35 (baseline)	0.44	1.00
Window 48 months, bandwidth 47	0.45	0.98 (with 36/35)
Window 60 months, bandwidth 59	0.48	0.94 (with 36/35)
Window 24 months, bandwidth 35	0.41	0.99
Window 60 months, bandwidth 35	0.55	0.97
Window 36 months, bandwidth 5	0.86	0.98
Window 36 months, bandwidth 15	0.57	0.99
Window 36 months, bandwidth 71	0.42	0.93
Window 36 months, sample-size rule (4 to 6 lags)	0.86	0.97

Two sample choices matter little for the aggregates: the exclusion of the revised-data variants and the treatment of the partial month. Including the three excluded variants of the revised-data strategy gives 176 variants, a median of 0.45, 59 variants at or above 0.5, a rank correlation with the Sharpe ratio of 0.62 and a 2000s-to-2010s rank correlation of −0.40. Keeping the partial September 2026 observation, as the platform's strategy pages do, leaves the median at 0.44 and the count at or above 0.5 at 56, and gives a rank correlation of 0.9999 with the completed-month values.

6.4 Bootstrap intervals

Figure 5 shows the 95 percent percentile intervals for the twelve highest and twelve lowest variants. All 173 percentile intervals exclude zero under both block lengths. This concerns positive mean rolling performance: it does not test whether temporal stability exceeds what rolling estimation on a constant positive Sharpe ratio would produce. Section 6.5 addresses that question with a permutation benchmark. No variant's 5th bootstrap percentile exceeds 0.5, and 9 variants have percentile intervals that lie entirely below 0.5. The median interval width is 0.46.

The bootstrap distributions are not centred on the point estimates for the steadiest strategies. Across the catalog the median ratio of bootstrap mean to point estimate is 1.03, but for the Momentum-Correlation Triplet the bootstrap mean is 0.69 against a point estimate of 0.91, and its percentile interval [0.44, 1.10] and basic interval [0.71, 1.38] give opposite answers about 0.5;

for Hybrid Asset Allocation the bootstrap mean is 0.58 against 0.48, with intervals [0.42, 0.84] and [0.13, 0.55]. Block resampling alters the long-run structure of a series, which may explain the downward shift for the steadiest strategies; the intervals are reported as descriptive and no coverage is claimed. Marginal intervals also say nothing about the uncertainty of differences between neighbours or of ranks, which would require synchronised resampling across strategies. The qualitative pattern, every interval above zero and no 5th percentile above 0.5, resembles the source paper's hedge fund findings, although the estimators, bootstrap designs and significance levels differ.

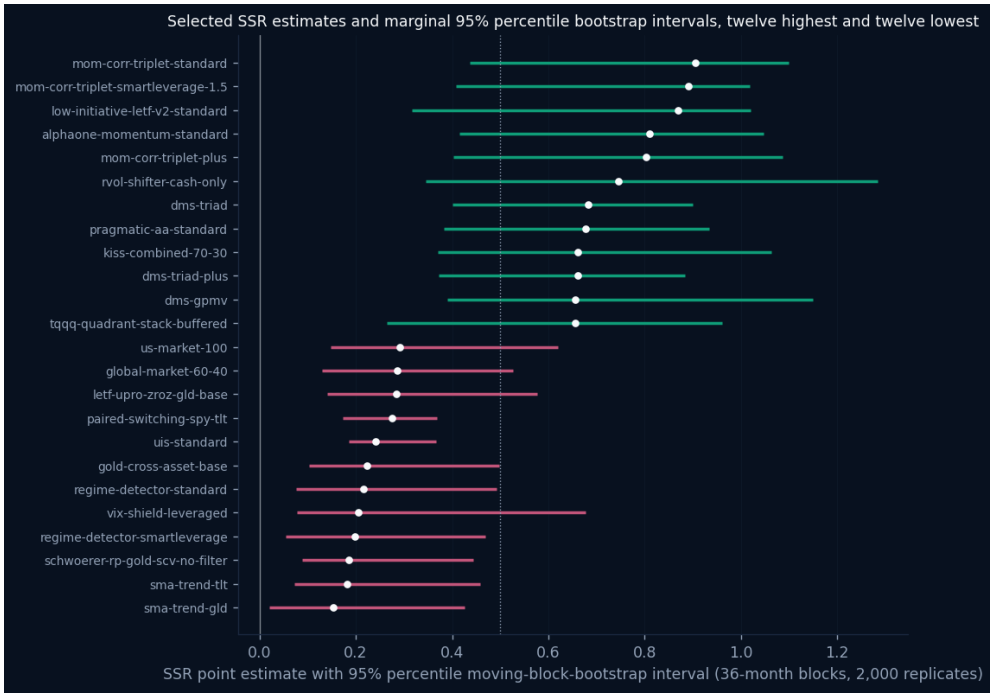


Figure 5. SSR point estimates with 95 percent percentile moving block bootstrap intervals (36-month blocks, 2,000 replicates), twelve highest and twelve lowest published variants.

6.5 Level and order: a permutation benchmark

Section 6.4 left open how much of a variant's SSR would arise from rolling estimation alone. A direct benchmark keeps each series' monthly returns and discards their order. Reordering a series' own returns at random leaves its mean, its standard deviation and its full-sample Sharpe ratio unchanged, and removes serial dependence, volatility clustering and regime structure. For every series we draw $B = 10{,}000$ random orderings, recompute the SSR on each with the estimator of Section 4.1, and report the mean of the reordered values, the permutation multiple (the real SSR divided by that mean) and the one-sided permutation p-value $(b+1)/(B+1)$, where b counts the orderings whose SSR is at least the real one (Phipson and Smyth, 2010). The comparison was suggested by Randy Harris of Dual Momentum Systems.

The reordered level is close to proportional to the Sharpe ratio and depends on the length of the history. Under independent normal monthly returns over 486 months, the median history in the sample, the mean SSR is 0.20, 0.40, 0.58 and 0.75 at annualised Sharpe ratios of 0.5, 1.0, 1.5 and 2.0, between 0.41 and 0.38 times the Sharpe ratio. Across the 173 variants a regression

of the reordered mean on the Sharpe ratio through the origin has a slope of 0.39 (Pearson correlation 0.97). At a Sharpe ratio of 1.0 the mean is 0.80 at the 120-month reporting gate (standard deviation 0.58), 0.50 at 220 months, the shortest history in the sample, 0.40 at 486 months and 0.36 at 1,274 months, the longest, consistent with the downward small-sample bias of kernel long-run variance estimates when the number of rolling estimates is not large relative to the window. SSR levels computed over histories of very different length are therefore not directly comparable, even with the same window and bandwidth. In this sample the effect on rankings is moderate, because most histories run between 428 and 630 months (tenth and ninetieth percentiles): the rank correlation between history length and the ratio of the reordered mean to the Sharpe ratio is −0.38, and between history length and the SSR itself 0.08. The three century-long series of Section 5.4 owe their low placing mainly to their Sharpe ratios; their multiples are 1.01 (Paired Switching), 0.90 (UIS) and 1.05 (classic 60/40).

Across the catalog the permutation multiple runs from 0.62 to 2.36, with a median of 1.13 and an interquartile range of 0.99 to 1.24; 16 variants have a multiple of at least 1.5, 3 of at least 2.0, and 44 at or below 1.0. A multiple above one means that the rolling Sharpe ratio was steadier, relative to its mean, than the same returns in random order would make it; a multiple below one means that good and bad months were more clustered in time than chance ordering produces. Twenty-seven variants have a permutation p-value below 0.05 and six below 0.01, against about 8.7 expected at 5 percent if no series had temporal structure and the tests were independent. The tests are not independent, since variants of one family share returns, and no variant remains below the threshold after a Benjamini and Hochberg (1995) false discovery rate adjustment at 5 percent. The excess of small p-values across the catalog is suggestive; no individual variant's multiple is established by this test.

The multiple removes most of the Sharpe level from the ranking. Its rank correlation with the Sharpe ratio is 0.05, against 0.61 for the SSR, and its rank correlation with the SSR is 0.75. Its rank correlation with the ratio of the SSR to the Sharpe ratio is 0.97: because the reordered mean is nearly proportional to the Sharpe ratio, the multiple is in practice the SSR-to-Sharpe ratio, rescaled and adjusted for history length and for the shape of the return distribution, and among histories of similar length it can be approximated from those two statistics.

Table 9 reports the benchmark for a subset of the strategies of Tables 4 and 5 and the two main benchmarks. The Momentum-Correlation Triplet, the DMS Triad and Pragmatic Asset Allocation, near the top of the SSR ranking, also have multiples well above one (1.89, 1.46 and 1.59), so their SSRs are not explained by their Sharpe levels alone; the twelve variants with the highest SSR in Table 4 all have multiples between 1.34 and 2.36, and eleven of them have permutation p-values below 0.05. Hybrid Asset Allocation, the highest-Sharpe strategy in Table 5, has a multiple of 0.86 on its full history: its SSR of 0.48 is below the mean of 0.57 for its own returns in random order, consistent with the long swings in its rolling Sharpe ratio shown in Figure 3. The S&P 500, the 60/40 blend and the three static allocations in the table sit between 0.94 and 1.29; the highest, All Weather, has a p-value of 0.066, and the other four are above 0.20.

Table 9. Permutation benchmark for selected series: the full-history SSR, the mean SSR of 10,000 random orderings of the same monthly returns (Random), their ratio (Multiple) and the one-sided permutation p-value, with the multiple and p-value on the window from January 2000, which every series in the table covers from its start.

Series	Sharpe	SSR	Random	Multiple	p	2000 on	p (2000)
Momentum-Corr. Triplet	1.25	0.91	0.48	1.89	0.003	1.90	0.011
DMS Triad	1.25	0.68	0.47	1.46	0.031	1.48	0.069
Pragmatic AA	1.13	0.68	0.43	1.59	0.014	1.43	0.082
LAA, Lethargic AA	1.18	0.63	0.45	1.40	0.049	1.59	0.041
BAA-G12, Bold AA	1.28	0.60	0.50	1.21	0.152	1.01	0.407
DAA-G12, Defensive AA	1.29	0.51	0.50	1.02	0.402	1.03	0.377
HAA, Hybrid AA	1.49	0.48	0.57	0.86	0.772	1.74	0.026
GTAA-5	1.14	0.46	0.43	1.07	0.309	0.96	0.481
GEM	1.05	0.41	0.40	1.01	0.419	1.10	0.301
Golden Butterfly	1.15	0.49	0.43	1.14	0.224	1.27	0.153
All Weather	1.07	0.52	0.40	1.29	0.066	1.10	0.294
Classic 60/40	0.79	0.31	0.29	1.05	0.302	1.14	0.248
Paired Switching	0.72	0.28	0.27	1.01	0.438	1.11	0.289
UIS	0.72	0.24	0.27	0.90	0.799	1.09	0.305
S&P 500 (VFINX)	0.82	0.32	0.31	1.02	0.405	1.13	0.268
60/40 (VFINX/VBMFX)	0.96	0.34	0.36	0.94	0.562	1.12	0.272

The multiple depends on the evaluation period as much as the SSR does. On the window from January 2000 the median multiple across the 166 variants with data is 1.22 and 31 have a p-value below 0.05; the rank correlation with the full-history multiple is 0.56. Hybrid Asset Allocation moves from 0.86 to 1.74 ($p = 0.026$), approaching the Triplet's 1.90, while the DMS Triad stays close to its full-history value (1.46 and 1.48). Whether a strategy's rolling Sharpe ratio looks more or less orderly than chance depends on which decades the window holds. The benchmark describes the realised series: it conditions on their returns and does not test whether those returns, or the rules that produced them, would recur.

7. The Deflated Sharpe Ratio and the SSR together

The Deflated Sharpe Ratio and the SSR answer different questions, and Table 10 shows that they classify the catalog differently at the thresholds the platform uses. Of the 173 variants, 152 have a Deflated Sharpe Ratio (219 trials) of at least 0.90, the platform's cutoff below which it flags a strategy as fragile. Of those 152, 55 have an SSR of at least 0.5 and 97 fall below that descriptive threshold. One variant has a Deflated Sharpe Ratio below 0.90 and an SSR of at least 0.5, and 20 fall below both thresholds. With the platform's current count of trials (Section 3.3) the four cells would hold 54, 95, 2 and 22. The chosen cutoffs produce different classifications in this selected catalog; neither classification establishes prospective credibility. The Credibility-Adjusted SSR of the source paper is numerically close to the SSR and produces identical ranks in this sample, because the Probabilistic Sharpe Ratio at zero is at least 0.9993 for every variant with a history this long.

Table 10. Joint classification of the 173 published variants by the Deflated Sharpe Ratio of Section 3.3 (threshold 0.90) and the full-history SSR (threshold 0.5).

	SSR at or above 0.5	SSR below 0.5
DSR at or above 0.90	55	97
DSR below 0.90	1	20

8. Turnover

The unadjusted association between reported annual turnover and SSR is positive: the rank correlation is 0.32 across the 173 variants. Table 11 splits the variants into turnover terciles with a deterministic tie policy (turnover, then variant identifier). The lowest tercile (turnover up to 1.4 times the portfolio per year) has a median SSR of 0.41, the middle tercile (1.4 to 3.0) 0.42 and the highest tercile (3.0 to 14.6) 0.51, with median full-sample Sharpe ratios of 0.95, 0.99 and 1.04. Figure 6 shows the relation. The terciles differ substantially in composition: all 31 static variants and all 27 annually or quarterly rebalanced variants are in the lowest tercile, while the top tercile is entirely tactical and holds 24 of the 52 leveraged variants. Within tactical variants the rank correlation between turnover and SSR is 0.25 (142 variants), and within monthly tactical variants 0.18 (117 variants), so static membership does not explain the whole association, but these descriptive comparisons do not isolate a turnover effect: strategy type, rebalancing frequency, leverage and asset exposures all move with turnover. Persistent asset exposures may contribute to period differences in rolling Sharpe ratios, and a defensive leg may reduce them; testing that explanation requires holdings and return attribution across market conditions, which this paper does not attempt.

Table 11. Turnover terciles, 173 published variants, full history, with composition.

Tercile	Annual turnover range	n	Median SSR	Median Sharpe	Tactical / static	Monthly / daily / other
Lowest	0.0 to 1.4	57	0.41	0.95	26 / 31	23 / 7 / 27
Middle	1.4 to 3.0	57	0.42	0.99	57 / 0	49 / 8 / 0
Highest	3.0 to 14.6	59	0.51	1.04	59 / 0	49 / 9 / 1

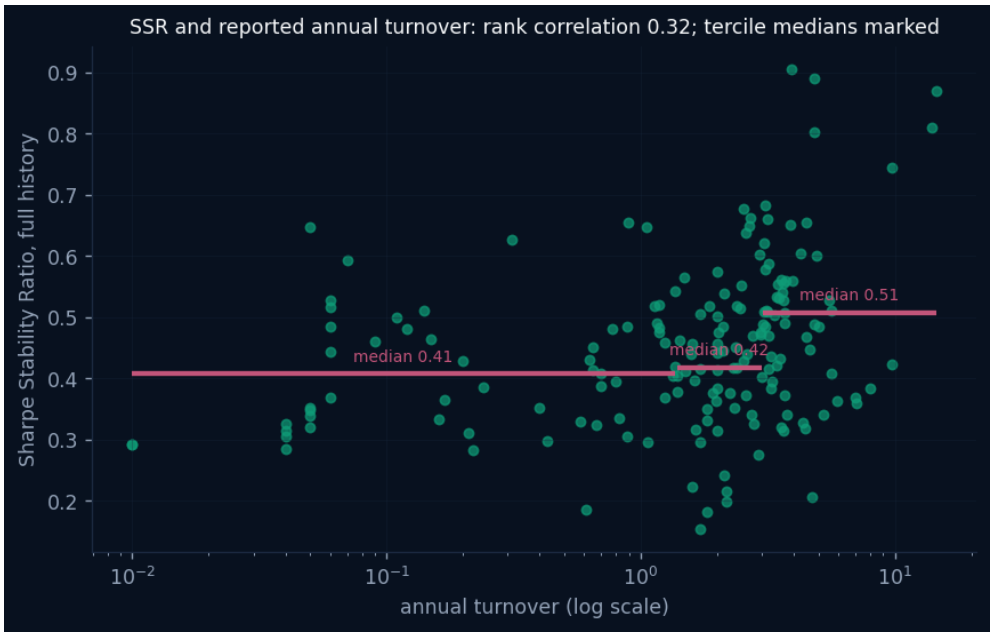


Figure 6. Full-history SSR against reported annual turnover (log scale), tercile medians marked. Rank correlation 0.32.

9. Limitations

Every strategy series here is a backtest produced by one engine under one execution convention, and the benchmark series are constructed from observed fund prices. The catalog is selected retrospectively: strategies entered it because their published or proposed backtests were attractive, its Deflated Sharpe Ratio represents a partial model of the recorded search and does not correct for catalog selection, for the searches upstream in the published research (Bailey, Borwein, López de Prado and Zhu, 2014; Harvey, Liu and Zhu, 2016), or for data errors, and the SSR inherits whatever look-ahead or proxy error the underlying series carry. Variants within a family are correlated and two share a return path, so cross-sectional counts overstate the number of independent strategies. Returns are used with a zero cash reference; an excess-return version would lower the rolling Sharpe ratios of high-rate decades and could change the ordering of strategies with different histories.

The estimator has two tuning choices, the window and the bandwidth. The bandwidth moves levels by a factor of two while leaving aggregate orderings largely intact, and the fixed 35-lag specification is a descriptive analogue rather than a consistent estimate of the structural ratio (Section 4.1); levels reported here should not be compared with levels computed under an automatic bandwidth rule, nor, without the benchmark of Section 6.5, across histories of very different length. The bootstrap uses fixed block lengths, its distributions are biased for the steadiest strategies, and no coverage has been validated. The permutation benchmark conditions on each series' realised returns and treats them as exchangeable under its null; it says nothing about whether those returns would recur, and its p-values are marginal, one per series, in a catalog whose variants share returns. The subperiod design compares unequal periods and cohorts, and the negative correlation between the 2000s and the 2010s, although robust to the bandwidth, has not been separated from estimation effects. Finally, the reported

comparisons show no consistent positive rank persistence across the selected historical periods, but prospective predictive value remains untested. Such a test does not require live histories: it requires frozen rules, defensible publication dates, point-in-time inputs and genuinely withheld evaluation data, in the sense of the discovery and embargo samples of López de Prado, Lipton and Zoonekynd (2026), and the retrospective selection of the present catalog makes those safeguards necessary.

10. Conclusion

This selected catalog illustrates how estimated SSR rankings differ from Sharpe and Deflated Sharpe rankings and how they vary across historical evaluation periods. The statistic resolves ties among strategies whose Deflated Sharpe Ratios round to one, it is imperfectly correlated with the Sharpe ratio, and its aggregate rankings are stable across the tested windows and bandwidths although individual ranks can move substantially. Its most important property in this sample is period dependence: the relative SSR of tactical strategies, static allocations and equity benchmarks changes from one decade to the next, and the S&P 500 moves from among the least stable series of the 2000s to among the most stable of the 2010s. That need not be a flaw in the statistic: one reading is that it reports, in one number, how different a strategy's risk-adjusted path looks depending on which regimes the window contains, although Section 6.2 lists the estimation effects that have not been separated from that reading. The permutation benchmark of Section 6.5 separates the two things the statistic combines: a level that scales with the Sharpe ratio and the length of the history, and an ordering component that is itself period-dependent. Interpretation remains conditional on data provenance, sample selection and the estimator's finite-sample behaviour, and the SSR is best read, as its authors suggest, as a description of a track record rather than a forecast.

Disclosure

The author operates BestFolio, the platform whose catalog is analysed here, and has a commercial interest in it. The study used the platform's stored series and public API and received no external funding. The statistic, its implementation and the data files are described in Appendix A so that the results can be checked independently.

AI use

The author used generative AI tools to assist with parts of the analysis code and the drafting of this paper, reviewed and edited the output as needed, and takes full responsibility for the content.

Changes from version 0.4

Version 0.5 recomputes every number, table and figure on restated data. The sample definition is unchanged: the same 219 variants, the same 177 published and 173 eligible variants, completed months through August 2026, the same exclusion, estimator, parameters and

random seeds, and the same count of trials for the Deflated Sharpe Ratio ($K = 219$, Section 3.3). On 28 September 2026 the platform restated every backtest for two reasons. First, the engine now holds positions between signals and lets their weights drift with prices, where it previously applied each signal's target weights to every session; turnover is measured from the drifted weights (Section 3.2). Second, several fund histories that serve as proxies in the early years lacked distributions in the price provider's records, mainly before 1990: bond, real estate and sector funds, and the S&P 500 index fund's distributions before 1980 and capital gains from 1979 to 1986. The distributions are restored, the S&P 500 proxy until early January 1987 is the index's daily total return, and the Nasdaq 100 proxy before October 1985 is a large-growth total-return index; the S&P 500, US bond, long Treasury and 60/40 benchmarks carry the same corrections, which leave their 2000 and 2008 windows unchanged. Among the headline figures, the maximum SSR moves from 0.98 to 0.91 and the median stays at 0.44; the rank correlation with the Sharpe ratio moves from 0.67 to 0.61 and with the Deflated Sharpe Ratio from 0.61 to 0.55; 152 variants rather than 146 reach a Deflated Sharpe Ratio of 0.90, of which 55 rather than 54 have an SSR of at least 0.5; the adjacent-subperiod rank correlations move from −0.04, −0.43 and 0.08 to −0.06, −0.40 and 0.10; and the S&P 500's full-history Sharpe ratio moves from 0.75 to 0.82 and its SSR from 0.30 to 0.32. Version 0.5 also adds Section 6.5 with its Table 9 (former Tables 9 and 10 are now Tables 10 and 11), the AI use statement, and a more precise description of the reference fixture in Section 4.4.

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Appendix A. Replication and provenance

Data. The sample is defined on the catalog of 5 September 2026 (release release/2026-09-05-8b44fa1): 219 active variants, 177 of them published. The month-end net asset value series of the same 219 variants, and the stored monthly moments of each variant's latest backtest, were extracted from BestFolio's production database on 28 September 2026, after that day's restatement (release release/2026-09-28-e9a2a80, methodology drift-until-flip-v1). The benchmark month-ends are the adjusted closes extracted on 5 September 2026, with the restatement's total-return corrections applied to VFINX, VBMFX and VUSTX by the platform's own correction code (build_bench_monthend.py). The leaderboard fields (turnover, strategy type, frequency, leverage, risk category, compound growth rate, maximum drawdown) were taken from the public endpoint /api/performance/leaderboard on 28 September 2026 for the same 177 published variants, and the Deflated Sharpe Ratio at $K = 219$ was computed with the platform's implementation (dsr_recompute.py), which first reproduces every live published score. The study script that produced the numbers in Sections 3 to 8 and the tables (ssr_paper_study_v2.py, Python with NumPy), the chart script, the independently computed reference fixture used to test the production implementation, the production-agreement check, the study outputs and the supplementary tables are published at https://github.com/lbonherbe/sharpe-stability-ratio-taa. The frozen month-end extracts are retained by the author and available to referees on request; they are not redistributed because the benchmark prices are licensed data and the catalog extract includes the unpublished research variants. The autocorrelation-adjusted Deflated Sharpe check of Section 2.1 and the reproduction of the Deflated Sharpe Ratios in Section 4.4 come from a separate script (ssr_catalog.py) run on the restated extract including the partial September 2026 month; its output is retained in the archive as RESULTS-ancillary-2026-09-28.md. The permutation benchmark of Section 6.5 comes from a third script (ssr_permutation_v05.py) run on the study's data with the same estimator; it stops unless every real SSR it computes equals the supplementary table, and its per-series output (permutation_results.csv), aggregate numbers (permutation_results.json) and console log are in the archive. The supplementary variant table holds the 177 published variants, with a flag on the three revised-data variants (the variant below the ten-year gate carries empty SSR fields) and, for each, the Sharpe ratio, Deflated Sharpe Ratio, Probabilistic Sharpe Ratio, the SSR on the full

history and on the 2000 and 2008 windows, the four subperiods with their return counts, the four joint window-bandwidth specifications, the four fixed bandwidths and the sample-size rule, the annualised mean rolling Sharpe ratio with the naive and HAC standard deviations of the rolling series, and, for the 173 eligible variants, the bootstrap mean, percentile and basic intervals, 5th percentile and proportion at or below 0.5 for 36-month blocks and the percentile interval and proportion for 12-month blocks.

Platform. The full-history statistic in US dollars is served on each strategy's summary endpoint, including the current partial month by the platform's convention; the values in this paper correspond to it with completed months only. The public leaderboard endpoint (/api/performance/leaderboard, field sharpe_stability, metadata ssr_meta with definition identifier ssr-36m-nw-v1) also carries the field for every leaderboard period and currency. The platform's methodology page documents the backtest conventions (transaction costs, execution timing, proxy chains) and the definition of the published Sharpe ratio.